

The 24-Hour *Rule*

Most of the yeses you regret were given in under ten seconds. This rule gives you a day.

THE RULE

Stop answering on the spot

When someone asks for your time, you do not answer in the moment. You buy a day. Then you decide with a clear head.

The one sentence

"Let me check my calendar and get back to you tomorrow."

Versions for every setting

IN A TEXT OR EMAIL

"Let me check my schedule and get back to you by [specific day]. I don't want to give you a rushed answer."

IN THE HALLWAY

"Let me check my calendar and get back to you tomorrow."

WHEN IT IS YOUR BOSS

"I want to say yes to the right things. Let me look at what's on my plate and get back to you tomorrow."

Before you answer, ask yourself

- ☐ Do I want to do this, or do I want to be someone who said yes?
- ☐ What does it replace? Name the thing.
- ☐ If it were happening tomorrow, would I still say yes?
- ☐ Is there a smaller yes that would be enough?

If the answer is no, the free Say No Scripts on laurenfine.com/resources have the wording.

Put the rule where the asks arrive

Most asks now come through your phone. Screenshot this card or save it, and set it as your lock screen for two weeks.



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Make Room For It

A free Facebook group for high achievers making room for what matters.

facebook.com/groups/permissiontochange

A free 55-minute session

Think it through with me. Leave with your next step. No sales pitch.

laurenfine.com/free-session